

With the help of Animate, you can touch up your character, layer them and convert your character head into different symbols. Make sure to analyse how the eyes and eye masks are ordered for extreme flexibility of facial expressions like blinking and looking. You can find the elements for creating the eye part in the Smart Graphic Control panel, and the eye mask is matched with the eye symbol.

After rigging the head of the character, you can save it in a library folder with proper names and prefixes to avoid any confusion. You can now convert this rig to smart rig.

Make sure all the joints and shapes are in different layers so you can manipulate it accordingly.

Auto Rig and Visual Rig Mapping

Animate has a unique feature for animators called Auto Rig Mapping. It rigs your character automatically and gives it motion. Example, in Adobe Animate, a character is given the motion of moving, jumping, running, and many more activities.

An Assets panel in a prepackaged form (default) offers these different rigs, or you can export it from the Customs tab. To use rig mapping –

1. Your character should be a symbol.
2. Every section of your character should also be a symbol.

When you apply rig mapping to your character, the asset is added to all parts of the character using the Bone tool.

Auto Rig mapping doesn't work all the time as the names of each character's part, and the rigs need to match. If Animate shows that it can't complete Auto Rig Mapping, it will open a Rig Mapping modal. This feature is called Visual Rig Mapping.

- Click on the node or the bone in the Rig Mapping modal.
- After that, you can click the section of the character that you want to map.
- The initial mapping begins with the root bone. The rest of the rigs are operated accordingly when the parent bones are mapped.
- Mapped bones are depicted as green, and when you try to work on it, the corresponding portion is also highlighted.
- If you make a wrong linking, then you can remove it by clicking the icon on the label.
- To reset all mapped bones, you can click on the reset option in the panel.